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# How to Be Filled and Empowered by the Holy Spirit

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Free media and discipleship resources for pastors, leaders, and growing disciples.

# How to Be Filled and Empowered by the Holy Spirit

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Being filled and empowered by the Holy Spirit is both a decisive moment and a continual lifestyle. The Holy Spirit already indwells every true believer at salvation, yet His filling refers to His control and power being released in ever-greater measure for obedience, witness, and fruitful living.

This empowerment flows from a living relationship with the Triune God — the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit. Our new life in Christ is supernatural precisely because it intimately involves all three Persons of the Godhead. We fellowship with the Father and the Son in the Holy Spirit. We obey the Son as we obey the Father. We follow the leading of the Holy Spirit as we follow Christ. Both the Son and the Spirit intercede for us. Yet we also relate to them distinctly: we submit to the Father's will, abide in the Son, and are filled with the Holy Spirit.

In *My Heart, Christ's Home*, Robert Munger wrote about having Christ control each "room" of a person's life. Envisioning what it would be like to have Jesus come to the home of our hearts, Munger goes from room to room considering what Christ desires for us. In the living room, we prepare to meet Christ daily. In the dining room, we examine what appetites should and should not control us. Munger even helps us explore the closets in our lives that Christ can help us cleanout. Think about what it would mean to give Christ control over all of your life! As your invited guest and Lord, Jesus desires to "settle down" in each "room" of your "house." Christ lives in you through the person of the Holy Spirit and He will take each area of your life which you commit to Him and help you to live for God.

## Prepare Yourself to Be Filled and Empowered by the Holy Spirit

Ask God to help prepare your heart through these simple yet powerful steps:

### 1. Desire to Be Filled

Jesus invites the thirsty to come to Him and drink. This step begins with honest hunger—a genuine desire for more of God and less of self. Ask the Father specifically and expectantly to fill you with the Holy Spirit. Come to Him with open hands and an expectant heart.

*"On the last day of the feast, the greatest day, Jesus stood up and shouted out, 'If anyone is thirsty, let him come to me, and let the one who believes in me drink. Just as the scripture says, "From within him will flow rivers of living water."' Now he said this about the Spirit, whom those who believed in him were going to receive" (John 7:37-39 NET).*

## **2. Confess and Repent of Known Sin**

Unconfessed sin grieves the Holy Spirit and quenches His work in your life. Agree with God about your sin and turn from it. His promise is clear.

*"If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us our sins and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness" (1 John 1:9).*

Confession clears the channel so the Holy Spirit can flow freely once again.

## **3. Surrender Every Area of Your Life to God**

True filling comes through surrender. This is not a one-time event but a daily, moment-by-moment choice. Present yourself as a living sacrifice. Submit your will to the Father, abide in Christ, and yield control to the Holy Spirit. The apostle Paul urged,

*"I plead with you to give your bodies to God. Let them be a living sacrifice, holy—the kind he can accept. When you think of what he has done for you, is this too much to ask? Don't copy the behavior and customs of this world, but be a new and different person with a fresh newness in all you do and think" (Romans 12:1-2).*

## **4. Walk in Obedience and Faith**

The filling of the Holy Spirit is maintained by daily obedience and dependence. Walk by the Spirit, putting on the armor of God and renewing your mind with Scripture. As you obey what the Spirit shows you, His power flows more freely in your life.

*"But I say, live by the Spirit and you will not carry out the desires of the flesh" (Galatians 5:16).*

## Ask God to Fill You with the Holy Spirit

Being filled is a lifestyle of coming under the loving leadership and righteous guidance of the Holy Spirit. It is a daily habit of surrender and faith.

**1. God commands** us to be filled with the Spirit.

*“And do not get drunk with wine, which is debauchery, but be filled by the Spirit” (Ephesians 5:18).*

**2. God promises** He will always answer when we pray according to His will.

*“And this is the confidence that we have before him: that whenever we ask anything according to his will, he hears us. And if we know that he hears us in regard to whatever we ask, then we know that we have the requests that we have asked from him” (1 John 5:14-15).*

**3. God fills** us when we ask by faith.

*“If you then, although you are evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will the heavenly Father give the Holy Spirit to those who ask him!” (Luke 11:13)*

We can be confident that he will listen to us whenever we ask him for anything in line with his will. And if we know he is listening when we make our requests, we can be sure that he will give us what we ask for.

So based on God’s command and his promise, express your desire to be shared with us. By faith through prayer.

Here is a simple prayer you may use or adapt into your own words. Remember, it is not the exact words that you use, but rather the attitude of your heart that is important.

*Dear Heavenly Father, I need You. I acknowledge that I have been directing my own life and have sinned against You. Thank You for forgiving my sins through Christ’s death on the cross. I now invite Christ to take His rightful place on the*

*throne of my life. Fill me with Your Holy Spirit as You commanded and promised. I pray this in the name of Jesus. I now thank You by faith that You have filled me with the Holy Spirit. Amen.*

Once you ask and trust Him, walk forward in the assurance that the Spirit is leading you. Stay attentive to His gentle guidance through thoughts, impressions, Scripture, and inner conviction — always consistent with God’s Word. If you knowingly disobey, confess quickly and ask God to once again fill you.

## The Holy Spirit as Your Constant Spiritual Charger

Think of a smartphone or laptop battery. Even the most advanced device eventually runs low and loses its ability to function well. It needs to be regularly connected to a power source to be recharged. Once connected, the charger steadily restores energy moment by moment until the battery is full again. The device can then operate at full capacity—bright screen, strong signal, and smooth performance.

The Holy Spirit is your constant spiritual Charger. Life’s demands, trials, distractions, and even ordinary routines can drain your spiritual strength. But when you stay connected to Him through surrender, prayer, and obedience, the Spirit continually recharges your inner life. He supplies fresh power for obedience, wisdom for decisions, love for difficult people, and strength for your calling. You were never meant to run on your own limited battery. Stay plugged in to the Holy Spirit, and you will live with supernatural vitality day by day.

## Spiritual Breathing: A Practical Way to Stay Filled

Bill Bright, founder of Campus Crusade for Christ, taught a simple yet profound practice called **Spiritual Breathing** to help believers live continually in the fullness of the Holy Spirit. He likened it to physical breathing: “a process of exhaling the impure and inhaling the pure, an exercise in faith that enables you to experience God’s love and forgiveness and walk in the Spirit as a way of life.”

- **Exhale** — Confess your sin. When you become aware of an attitude, word, or action that grieves the Holy Spirit, agree with God about it (1 John 1:9), thank Him for His forgiveness on the basis of Christ’s finished work, and turn from it.
- **Inhale** — Surrender control to Christ and, by faith, ask the Holy Spirit to fill and empower you afresh.

This moment-by-moment practice helps you move from a spiritual roller coaster of defeat and frustration to consistent victory and fruitfulness. It is not a complicated ritual but a simple exercise of faith that keeps the channel open between you and God.

## **Important Clarifications**

Being filled with the Holy Spirit is repeatable—you can be filled many times. Ask daily or even moment by moment. The primary evidence is Christ-like fruit (Galatians 5:22-23), boldness in witness, love for God and others, power in prayer and ministry, and alignment with Scripture.

Gifts and experiences may vary and should always be tested by the Word of God. This is not a second work of grace in the sense of reaching a new “level” of salvation, but rather a deeper surrender to what you already have in Christ. Above all, avoid extremes. Do not seek bizarre manifestations or emotional highs as the goal. Instead, seek the Giver Himself, not the gifts. As you do, the Holy Spirit will faithfully fill and empower you for a life that honors God and bears lasting fruit.

# Thank you for downloading this free resource!

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In Christ,

**The JesusOnline Ministries Team**

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